Nico Rubino

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SUMMARY

Accounting student at Western Governors University (27 competency units remaining, completion targeted 2027) with four years of payer-side financial work inside a medical practice: appeals, denial management, authorization, and the compliance documentation that supports both. Builds the Python tooling that removes manual handling from that work. Seeking an entry-level accounting, audit, or financial-operations role in Tampa Bay.

EXPERIENCE

Practice Operations & Technology Associate Sep 2024 — Present

NEXGEN Hyperbarics — Naples, FL

- Draft clinical justification narratives and formal insurance appeal letters citing payer policy-level evidence, producing overturned adverse determinations on appealed denials.
- Manage prior authorization workflows for chronic migraine therapeutics across commercial and Medicare Advantage payers, verifying each patient against payer-specific coverage criteria before submission.
- Assemble screening results and compliance documentation into authorization and appeal packets; maintain confidential records under HIPAA for legal requests, payer audits, and external review.
- Maintain federal DEA controlled-substance compliance: confirm urine drug screening precedes prescribing, keep result documentation current, and verify physician adherence to federal prescribing guidelines.
- Built a Python OCR-to-classification-to-routing pipeline integrating the AthenaOne REST API, CoverMyMeds ePA webhooks, and fax ingestion, removing manual document triage from the practice's daily workflow; PHI boundaries enforced at the routing layer. The same pattern applies to invoice and remittance handling.

Chef de Partie — Prepared Foods 2022 — 2024

Whole Foods Market — Naples, FL

- Ran high-volume production in a USDA/FDA-regulated kitchen with HACCP compliance, cold-chain integrity, portion-cost controls, and inventory rotation; trained 3–5 team members per shift.

EDUCATION

Western Governors University — B.S. Accounting, in progress · 27 competency units remaining · completion targeted 2027

Completed: federal taxation. In progress: financial accounting (journal entries, adjusting entries, trial balance, bank reconciliation), cost and managerial accounting, business law, accounting information systems. 150-credit CPA pathway planned after the B.S.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Healthcare Document Automation — Built and ran in a live practice: OCR to classification to routing across the AthenaOne REST API, CoverMyMeds ePA webhooks, and fax ingestion, with PHI boundary enforcement at the routing layer.

Systematic Research Framework — Python framework for strategy development: multi-asset data ingestion, signal computation, and walk-forward validation with embargo periods and sequential kill gates. Version-controlled, with post-mortems on methods that failed their own measurement gates.

Personal Knowledge & Retrieval Architecture — Hybrid retrieval over a 10,000+ document corpus: FTS5 keyword search for exact terms plus a semantic layer for conceptual queries, with per-corpus index isolation across roughly 75 project records.

SKILLS

Accounting: federal taxation (completed coursework) · cost and managerial accounting (in progress) · business law (in progress) · QuickBooks (ProAdvisor exam in progress)

Payer & Claims: payer receivables · insurance appeals · denial management · prior authorization · step therapy verification · payer policy analysis · coverage criteria review

Compliance & Records: DEA controlled-substance compliance · HIPAA · records management · audit packet assembly · audit support

Programming & Data: Python (NumPy, Pandas) · SQL · JavaScript · Git · REST API integration · OCR pipelines · Excel

CERTIFICATIONS & LEADERSHIP

Google IT Support Professional Certificate (2021) · QuickBooks ProAdvisor (exam in progress)

Assistant Scoutmaster, Troop 165 — youth leadership development, expedition planning, merit badge instruction.